

INTRODUCTION

Envy is a powerful emotion that threatens one’s perception of social standing. Ideally, people want life’s many aspects to be split equally, satisfying the need for fairness. When another receives what a person feels they deserve, this creates a feeling of envy to have what others currently possess, or will possess, providing evidence that there is a difference in social equality. Thus, researching how temporally centered feelings of envy influence the individual is vital to better understanding society.

PURPOSE

To recreate the study conducted by Kristal et al., 2019. we further explored the effect that envisioning a friend in alternative envious events in either anticipation or reflection has on the level of envy in an individual.

HYPOTHESIS

We hypothesized that multiple perceived enviable events would present as less envious when the event has occurred in the past as opposed to one that will occur in the future.

METHOD

Participants

Participants included 235 undergraduate students; 70.8% females, 83.5% White; age= 52.7% 18 years of age.

Procedure

In a mixed method design, participants were randomly assigned to either the Past or Future group. Both groups were presented the 5 events, and their envy scores were reported.

Measures

- Each participant imagined a friend (specifically not a significant other or romantic partner), getting five dream scenarios.
- All participants reported their level of envy in response to five questions for each imagined scenario. These questions, rated on a Likert scale from 1 (not at all) to 7 (extremely), were designed to understand their level of envy.

RESULTS

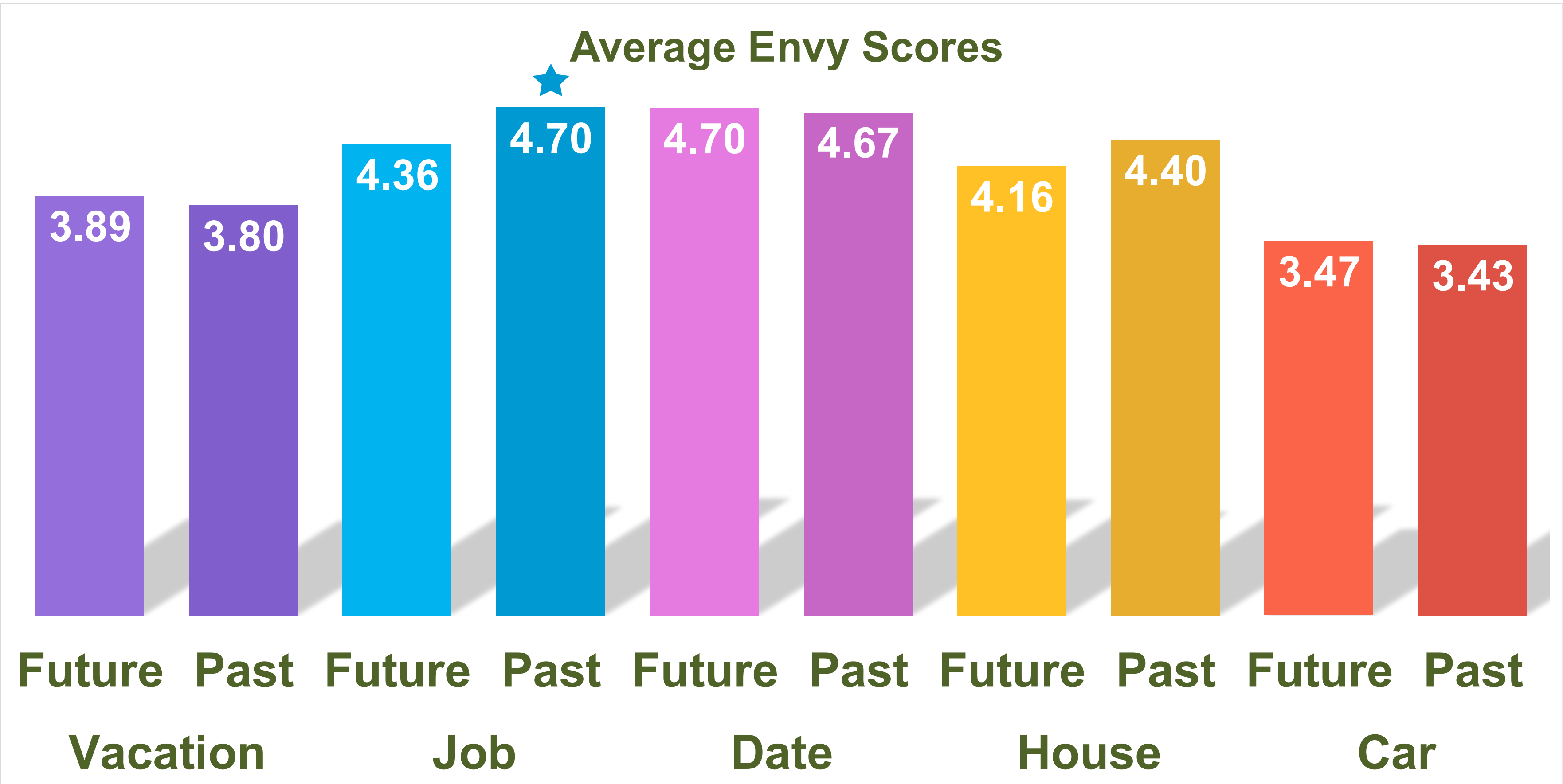


Figure 1. Reported Envy Scores by Imagined Event

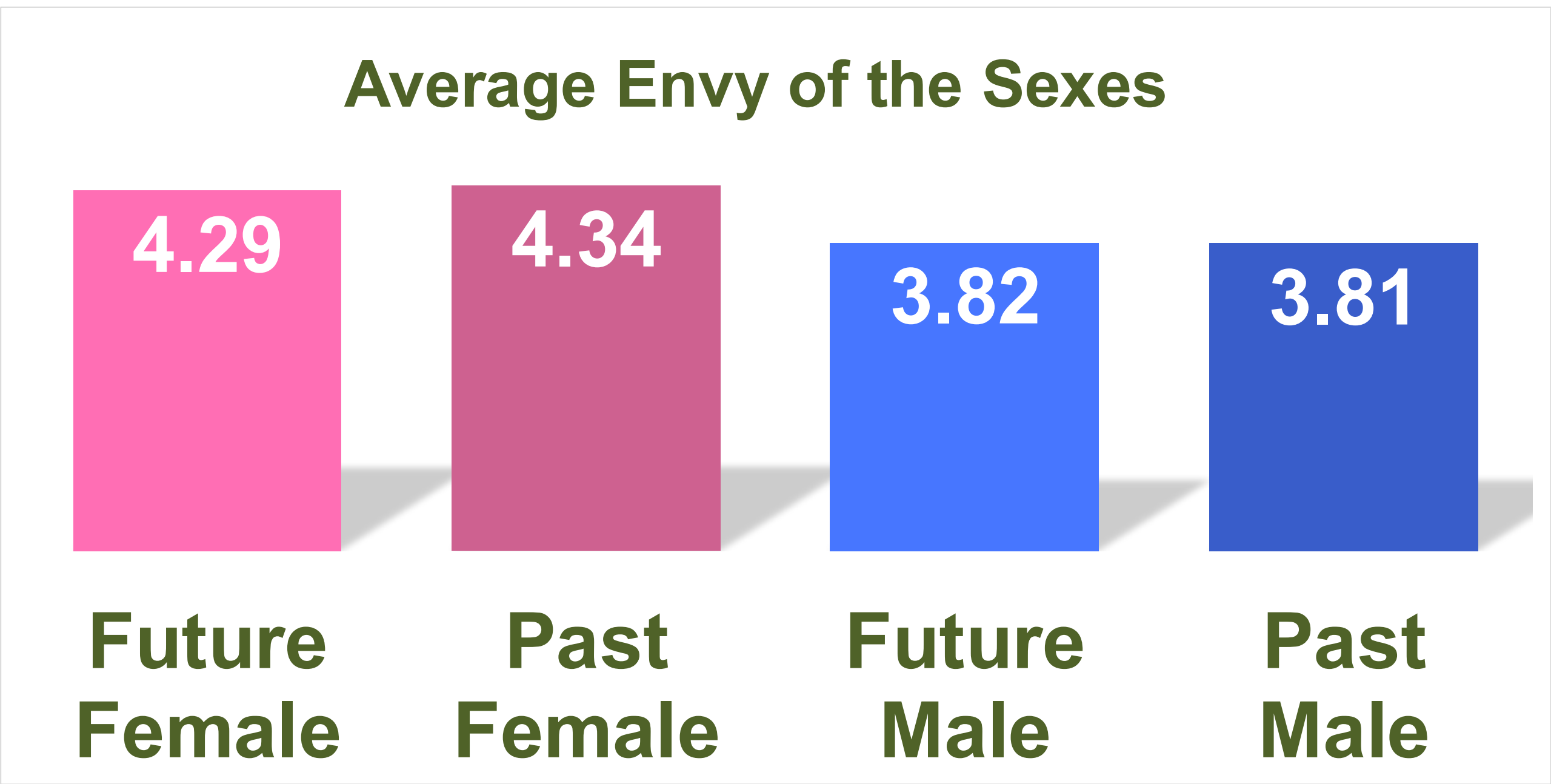


Figure 2. Reported Envy Scores of Sex & Tense

Note: There were 166 female respondents and 66 males. There were 3 respondents who reported non-binary, but with not enough participants for the gender ANOVA, those responses were omitted.

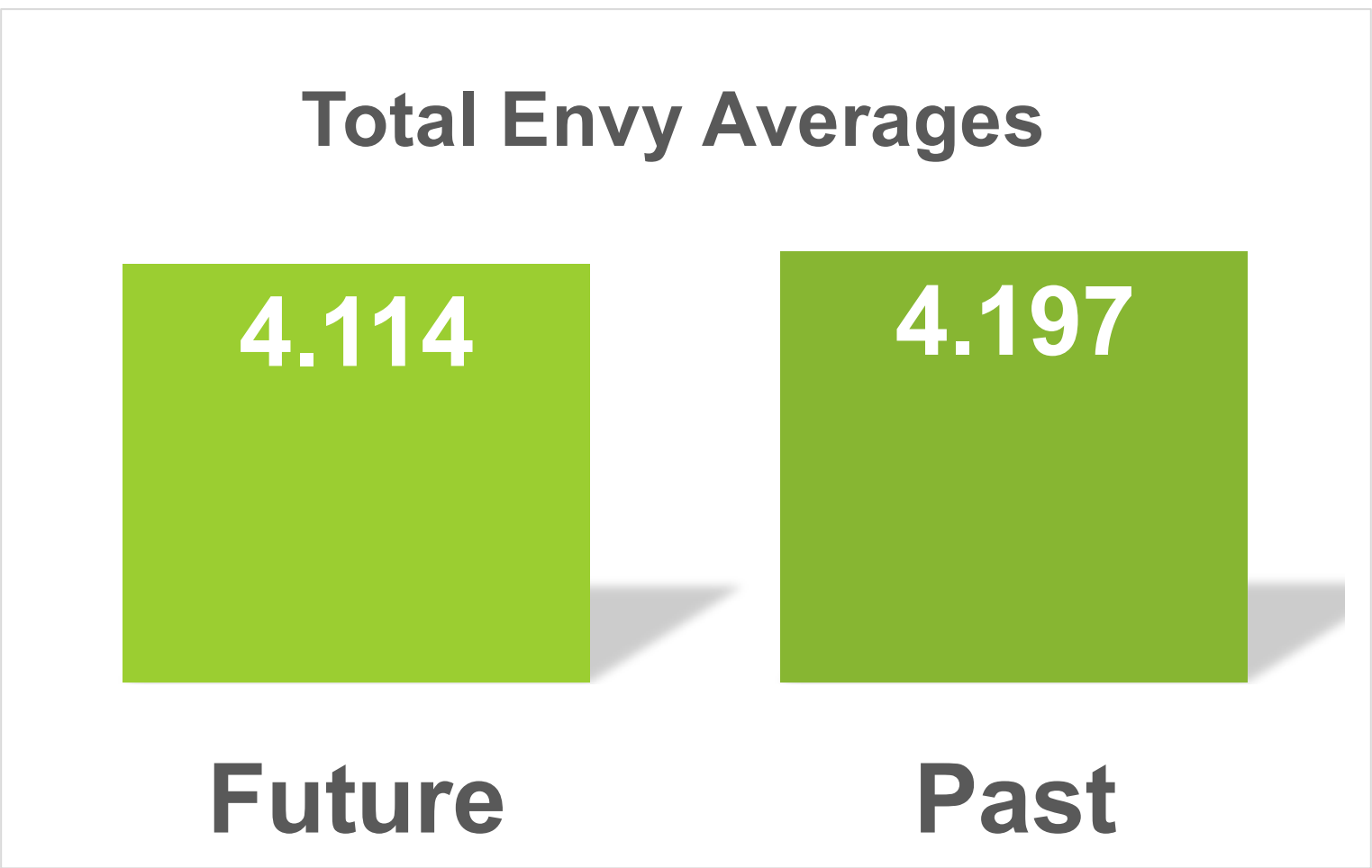


Figure 3. Comparisons of All Envy

Note: An independent samples *t*.test shows a non-significant result: *t*(233) = -0.516 *p*-value = 0.303

Table 1 *Inferential Analysis Results - t(233)*

Independent Samples T.Test			
VACATION	<i>t</i> = 0.53	<i>d</i> = 0.07	<i>p</i> = 0.29
JOB	<i>t</i> = -1.82	<i>d</i> = -0.24	<i>p</i> < 0.05
DATE	<i>t</i> = 0.18	<i>d</i> = 0.02	<i>p</i> = 0.43
HOUSE	<i>t</i> = -1.19	<i>d</i> = -0.16	<i>p</i> = 0.11
CAR	<i>t</i> = 0.18	<i>d</i> = 0.02	<i>p</i> = 0.43

A significant *p*-value was found for the job event. Opposite to the original hypothesis, envy reports for job and house were higher in reflection than in anticipation. (See Table 1 and Fig. 1).

Table 2 *ANOVA results of Gender and Tense*

Between Subjects ANOVA Test			
Effect	F(1, 228)	η²	p-value
Tense	0.011	4.74×10−5	<i>p</i> = 0.92
Gender	8.276	0.035	<i>p</i> < 0.01
Tense x Gender	0.158	1.48×10−4	<i>p</i> = 0.69
Post Hoc Comparisons (Sheffé)			
Contrast	Mean Estimate	<i>t</i> (288)	p-value
Future vs Past	-0.019	<i>d</i> = -0.15	<i>p</i> = 0.92
Female vs Male	0.507	<i>d</i> = 0.419	<i>p</i> < 0.01

A significant *p*-value was found when comparing gender. Findings show that females reported on average 0.5 higher envy than males in our study. (See Table 2 and Fig. 2).

CONCLUSION

- For the job event, average envy reports of the past group compared to the future group was the most significant of our findings, this could be due to the career-focus of BYU-Idaho.
- The events of job, date, and house were on average 1 point higher than vacation and car. This difference could be reflective of the life goals and desires of the students.
- The car event was the least envious scenario, the only one below 3.5, this could be reflective of students either having a car or knowing how to live well enough without one.

- We believe that further studies into how envy affects women would be very beneficial based on our reports from women being on average 0.5 greater than the men of our study.
- Closeness to friend reports were slightly higher on average (0.052) in the Past group than the Future group.
- Overall envy reports were opposite to our original hypothesis with anticipation (past) being higher than reflection (future), the findings were not significant *p* = .303.